gay nightclub in Orlando; the explosion that killed more than 300 people in a Baghdad market.

The Brexit vote was a victory for right-wing populism, a political current that was making an ominous resurgence across the Western world, with an assist from the jihadis in Raqqa. In a deeply Euroskeptic France, Marine Le Pen, the leader of the xenophobic National Front, was a credible contender for president, though she would eventually be defeated. Yet her poll numbers rose after the deadly truck-ramming attack in Nice. In Austria, a right-wing party founded by former Nazis came within 30,000 votes of winning the presidency. Amidst all of this, the Turkish military tried to stage a coup. It failed, giving the long-serving Islamist president, Recep Tayyip Erdogan, the pretext he needed for a purge that was breathtaking in its scope: tens of thousands of officers, civil servants, academics, even stockbrokers and leaders of the football association caught up in the "cleansing".

Across the Atlantic, meanwhile, Donald Trump continued his unlikely ascent. He was the most ill-qualified presidential candidate in modern American history, a charlatan who based his campaign on racism and hollow nationalism. Yet he easily dispatched a dozen rivals to win the Republican nomination. His 75-minute acceptance speech at the Republican convention in Cleveland that summer was a bleak, despairing portrait of a shattered nation on the brink of collapse.

Israel does not exist in isolation. It likes to see itself as an outpost of the West in the Middle East—the "villa in the jungle," as Ehud Barak infamously put it. By the summer of 2016, with liberalism beating a hasty retreat across Europe and the United States, it was tempting to see Israel as a sort of leading indicator. Indeed, watching the Brexit vote, it was easy to see parallels with Israel's own election, fifteen months earlier. Cameron and his Remain camp cited experts to make an economic argument: leaving the union would sink the pound and roil the markets, they warned. It was a message that proved utterly ineffective. "People in this country have had enough of experts," said Michael Gove, the justice secretary and a Leave supporter, in what became one of the campaign's most memorable lines. The Remain camp never made a positive case for staying in the EU. There was little talk of the centuries of shared history between Britain and the continent, of their common destiny, of the EU's role in ending horrific bloodshed.